A2 - Written Mediation 1: Learning Sequence

Let's celebrate!

Your friend Martina lives in Northern Ireland. She is preparing an oral presentation for her school. She has been to Spain several times with her family on holiday, and she loves our country. She is very interested in Spanish traditions and celebrations, so she has chosen to speak about them. She has sent you an e-mail asking for help: she needs some information about the most typical celebrations and what people in Spain do to keep traditions alive. She knows that some of the things that we do to celebrate festivities in Spain are different from the things people do in Northern Ireland, so she needs your help to get to know them. You write her an e-mail giving her some information about the most popular celebrations in Spain.

Spanish traditions and celebrations



New Year's Eve

On New Year's Eve, Spanish people eat 12 grapes when the clock strikes 12 times at midnight. According to the tradition, this will bring you good luck for new year.



San Fermin

San Fermin is celebrated in the city of Pamplona. On the 7th July, local people and tourists share a good time together dancing, playing music and eating typical food. People wear white and red clothes.

La Tomatina

At the end of the month of August, a small town in Valencia celebrates La Tomatino. Floats are driven around the streets and the people on them throw soft tomatoes at people. It is a very colourful celebrations.



Flamenco

It is a type of music that is played with a guitar, but there are also other instruments that can be used. There is usually one singer, and flamenco dancers perform typical flamenco choreographies. Woman dancers wear special flamenco dresses.



Blooming Cherry Trees

Extremadura celebrates this festivity in March. People go to the cherry tree orchards to see the new season's blossoms. There are many activities in the town of Valle del Jerte and people have a great time

Your e-mail to Martina should have between 65 to 80 words. Remember that you have to use paragraphs and follow the structure of an informal e-mail.



In written mediation, you need to understand the texts and the images provided. When you understand all the ideas, try to explain your message in your own words.

Make sure it is clear why you are talking about the topic. Refer to the context. Underline the words and expressions that will help you to understand the text better.

Let's get ready!

1. Analyse the task

a. Read the task carefully and answer these questions. They will help you choose the register of the mediation task.

   a) Who will receive the e-mail?

   b) Why is she asking you for help?

   c) What are you going to write about?

b. After analysing the task, choose the correct answer.

   a) In a mediation task you *have to* / *don´t have to* be clear about the message.

   b) In a mediation task, *it is* / *it is not* important to pay attention to the register.

   c) Written language tends to be more *formal* / *informal* than oral language.

2. Analyse the information

Read the information in the poster carefully.

   a) What is the important information in the poster that your friend needs?

   b) Underline the ideas that are important for Martina´s project.

Let's prepare the language!

1. Discuss advantages and benefits

1. Read this text where a person is writing about the importance of traditions. Read carefully and underline the connectors you see.

From ancient times, people have celebrated a good harvest. Having plenty of cereals, fruit and vegetables was a sign of a prosperous year ahead. However, not all the years had reasons to celebrate. Plagues, floods and droughts were problems that affected harvests. Despite the effort of farmers, climate conditions could ruin the economy of an entire village as this was a factor they could not control. Moreover, a lot of people could have serious problems even to survive. That is why good harvests were celebrated with such joy and how season festivities have come down to us.

We still depend on good harvests to live but our reality is completely different. We still try to keep traditions alive and season festivities are the perfect excuse to visit interesting places and learn about other cultures.

In addition, the beginning of spring or summer have also been a reason to celebrate. Temperatures got warmer and the cold winter was finished. Nowadays, we are not so exposed to extreme weather. Nevertheless, we will always find a reason to celebrate old traditions!

Other Useful Language

For example, …
For instance, …
… , such as …
A typical example is …
To give you an idea, …
… an example being …

Do not use the same expressions all the time. It is important to vary your language to show that your skills are improving.



2. Read the words below and classify them into two categories.

rain drought flood plague sun soil

GOOD FOR HARVESTS	BAD FOR HARVESTS

2. Give reasons and examples

1. Give a reason and an example that support each of the statements below.

a) Having good harvests is important for the population.

_____

b) Natural disasters can affect harvests.

_____

Let's mediate!

Your friend Martina lives in Northern Ireland. She is preparing an oral presentation for her school. She has been to Spain several times with her family on holiday, and she loves our country. She is very interested in Spanish traditions and celebrations, so she has chosen to speak about them. She has sent you an e-mail asking for help: she needs some information about the most typical celebrations and what people in Spain do to keep traditions alive. She knows that some of the things that we do to celebrate festivities in Spain are different from the things people do in Northern Ireland, so she needs your help to get to know them. You write her an e-mail giving her some information about the most popular celebrations in Spain.

1. Content

Content

Look at the poster on page 1 and read the information there carefully again. Select the information you are going to tell your friend Martina. You can use the following questions:

- Which festivities are related to food in any way?
- Which festivities involve special clothes?

2. Language

Language

Use your own words. Simplify or paraphrase the information.

Remember to adapt your register to the task and addressee.

Vary the language you use. Look at the Other Useful Language on page 3.